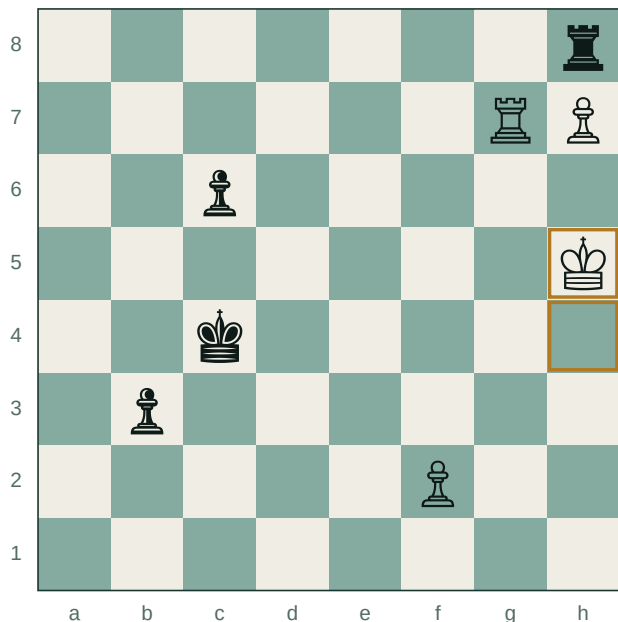


# Deflection tactics: Black, move 50

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 50.Kh5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**50...b2 51. Rb7 Rxh7+ 52. Rxh7 b1=Q**

**50...b2** The pawn moves from b3 to b2. Recorded reply: **51.Rb7**.

**51...Rxh7+** Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From h7 it attacks king on h5 and rook on b7. Recorded reply: **52.Rxh7**.

**52...b1=Q** The pawn moves from b2 to b1. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from +0 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on h5. Absolute pin: pawn on h7.